

831–840



The area around Segesta in Sicily, with its Greek ruins, was occupied early in the Aghlabid invasion of the island.

Louis' co-emperor since 824, rallied his brothers in revolt against their father. In early 830, **Louis was deposed**, and although Lothair's misrule saw his father restored by the autumn, the older man's authority was compromised and the scene set for worse conflict to come.

Wessex, the Anglo-Saxon kingdom in south and west England, became the **dominant English power** as a result of the victory of King Egbert over King Beornwulf of Mercia at the Battle of Ellandun, Wiltshire, in 825. Egbert was subsequently able to conquer the southeastern counties of England, and by around 828 Wessex was the most powerful state in the land, with Egbert recognized as *bretwalda*, or overlord, of England until his death in 839.

The emergence of **Great Moravia** began around 830, with the establishment of the Principality of Moimir, to the west of the White Carpathians, under the rule of **Moimir I**. Moimir was one of two Slavic polities to establish themselves in the power vacuum left by the collapse of the Avars in 805; the other—to the east of the White Carpathians, in what is now Slovakia—was Nitra, under the rule of **Prince Pribina**. In 833, Moimir would conquer Nitra, setting his principality on the path to becoming the **Great Moravian Empire**.

THE ISLAMIC CONQUEST OF SICILY had begun in 827 with the arrival of an invasion force from Aghlabid in North Africa, sent by the **Emir Ziyadat Allah I** (r. 817–38) to take advantage of **internal divisions** among the **Byzantine** rulers of the island. Hindered by outbreaks of plague, the Islamic forces made little headway until 831, when **Palermo** fell after a year-long siege. The city then became the capital of Islamic Sicily, although total conquest of the island did not happen until 902.

The Field of Lies, in Alsace in 833, was a meeting brokered by

the Pope to mediate between the **Frankish rulers**, which resulted in the desertion of Louis the Pious and Charles the Bald by their followers, and their subsequent imprisonment. This was one episode in a series of conflicts that saw the collapse of central authority and increasing Frankish vulnerability to raids from the Norsemen to the north and west, **Bulgars** and **Magyars** to the east, and **Saracen** pirates to the south.

Saracen warriors

"Saracens" was a European term for Muslims, especially those occupying Sicily and raiding Europe.



841–850



The ancient city of Pagan, in Burma, became the capital of a powerful Buddhist state occupying roughly the same area as the current region.

THE TREATY OF VERDUN in 843 marked the definitive division of Charlemagne's empire. After the death of Louis the Pious in 840, his three surviving sons (see 821–30) embroiled themselves in further conflict over land. In 842, Charles the Bald and Louis the German teamed up and swore oaths to impose a settlement on Lothair that saw the **Frankish Empire divided** into regions. These broadly equated to France in the west, Germany in the east, and a middle kingdom that would later become known as *Lotharii regnum*, or Lotharingia (modern Lorraine).

The rise of the **Cholas**, a Tamil dynasty of **southern India**, can be dated to 846, when the Chola king Vijayalaya captured the city of Tanjore from the **Pandya kingdom**.

The **Capitulary of Meerssen** was a proclamation by the West Frankish king Charles the Bald in 847, ordering every free man to choose himself a lord. Charles intended the decree to facilitate the levy of armies, but it was also indicative of the increasing inability of the Frankish rulers to protect their subjects. In place of central authority, the peasants relied on local lords; they gave up freedoms and bound themselves to a feudal aristocracy in return



Coffee plant

The coffee bush is native to the mountains of Ethiopia and Yemen, where it was first recorded in use in the mid-15th century.

for protection from **Vikings** and other raiders.

In around 848, the **Burmese city-state of Pagan** was founded in the Irrawaddy Valley. Indian influence is readily perceptible in the architecture of this part of Southeast Asia due to cultural, religious, and mercantile ties.

The legendary **discovery of coffee** is dated to around 850, when it is said that an Ethiopian goatherd named Kaldi noticed that, after eating some red berries, his goats became extremely lively. He brought a sample to a local Islamic holy man, who, disapproving of intoxicants, threw them on the fire, where they roasted and released a delicious aroma.

c. 830 Principality of Moimir, which will become the Great Moravian Empire, established

830 Civil strife in Carolingian Empire

831 Islamic conquest of Sicily continues; capture of Palermo

833 War in Deccan; Gurjara kingdom of North India diminished

833 Field of Lies: Louis the Pious deposed, Charles imprisoned

833 Al Mu'tasim accedes to Abbasid caliphate, creates ghulam slave army of Turks

836 Bhoja restores Gurjara kingdom in India

836 Vikings raid inland Ireland

840 Collapse of Uighur Empire, Central Asia; driven out by the Khirgiz they settle in Tarim Basin

838 Death of Pepin; division of Frankish Empire

841–42 Civil war between sons of Louis the Pious

841 Viking kingdom of Dublin founded

842 Vikings sack London

846 Chola king Vijayalaya captures Tanjore from Pandyas; rise to power of Chola dynasty

843 Treaty of Verdun ends Carolingian civil war

848 Founding of Burmese city-state of Pagan

c. 850 Earliest gunpowder in China

c. 850 First Islamic astrolabes

c. 850 Legendary discovery of coffee

c. 850 Collapse of Tibetan Empire